

Choices in Tony's talk: Phonological paragraphing, information unit nexuses and the presentation of tone units

Gerard O'Grady^a

5.1 Introduction

This chapter aims to examine the neglected role intonation plays in projecting the texture of a spoken text.¹ By texture I refer to the way a text is given unity within the particular context in which it is produced (Halliday and Hasan, 1976: 2). Much has been written on the devices writers use to give texture to their texts, for example the choice of Theme, lexical repetition, anaphora, deixis, elision, substitution, expansion and projection. Much has also been written about the effects of these choices, and how they not only give unity to texts but also orientate the reader along a favoured pathway. Outside the SFL tradition, scholars such as Nation (1984), have noted that paragraphing not only projects tactic relations between clauses and clause complexes, but also indicates which clause complexes are given more weight, or, in other words, are more central to the achievement of the text producer's message. The paragraph structure of a text helps to guide the reader along a reading pathway. Within SFL, scholars such as Martin (1992), Martin and Rose (2003) and Hood (2009) noted the repeated patterning of stages within texts, which operate within the same field.

Far less has been written on the texturing of spoken texts, and less again on the effects of the devices speakers choose to make their texts 'texts'.

^a Gerard O'Grady lectures at the Centre for Language and Communication Research in Cardiff University. His chief research interests are Critical Discourse Analysis, SFL – especially in investigating connections between intonation and the lexicogrammar, examining differences between language as process and product, and examining how spoken discourse unfolds and creates meaning in real time. He is the author of *A Grammar of Spoken English Discourse and Key Concepts in Phonetics and Phonology*.

Any text is open to multiple readings, some of which may potentially be resistant though speakers, as text producers, may attempt to constrain their hearers' 'readings' by organizing a text in a manner which foregrounds certain 'interpretative' pathways over others. I am using the term 'interpretative' pathway in a manner analogous to 'reading pathway' (see, e.g., Coffin and Derewianka, 2008). Speakers' intonation choices project an organization on their texts, which they use to guide their hearers' interpretative choices. Speakers make tonality choices to segment the stream of speech into information units. Within the information units their tonicity selections project the focus of information and demarcate the extent of the New. Their tone selections project the tactic relationships between adjoining tone units, and their choice of high or low pitch level may project a spoken paragraph or paratone structure.

Much has been written on the roles of tonality and tonicity in segmenting the stream of speech into information units and in dividing the information unit into Given and New elements (e.g. Halliday, 1967, 1970; Halliday and Greaves 2008; Tench 1990, 1996). Yet, other than studies such as Brown *et al.* (1980), Brazil (1997), Tench (1996) and especially Wichmann (2000), little has been written about how intonation choices operating above the tone unit organize the speaker's instantiation of his/her spoken text into spoken paragraphs or paratones, and how the paratone structure creates texture by signalling which tone units are united within the same paratone and which are separated by being placed in separate paratones.

Almost nothing, with the exception of a brief outline in Halliday (2005), Halliday and Greaves (2008: 130–32) and Smith (2008: 123–5), has been written regarding how tone choices project the logico-semantic flow of information construed within the clauses which in speech are instantiated as tone units. To my knowledge, with the exception of Wichmann (2000), no previous work has explored the relationship between written paragraphs and paratones, and the relationship between paratones and phases of text. I am unaware of any previous work, which has employed a corpus to investigate how speakers use tone to project logico-semantic meaning and to explore how different speaker choices create different interpretative pathways. This chapter aims to contribute to existing knowledge by shedding some light on the following three questions.

- What is the relationship between paratones and written paragraphs?
- What is the relationship between paratones and stages of the text?
- Within clause nexuses, how do speakers use intonation to project logio-semantic meaning?

5.2 The text and the readers

The text chosen for analysis is the short statement made by the then UK prime minister Blair to the television cameras from the G8 conference at Gleneagles, expressing his first reaction to the London underground bombings of 7 July 2005. The authorship of the text is not clear, but it is a prepared speech which Blair delivered in his name. While not necessarily the physical producer or creator of the text, Blair, as the person who assumes ethical responsibility for the speech, can be considered its author. In Goffman's terms he assumes the role of the author as 'someone whose position is established by the words that are spoken, someone whose beliefs have been told, someone who is committed to what the words say' (Goffman, 1981: 146).

The text was subsequently published on the official UK government website, www.direct.gov.uk, and the written version published there is the text used here in the clause analysis. The text is presented in Appendix 1 with the orthographic paragraphs notated by capital letters from A to F. In his subsequent autobiography Blair stated that the purpose of the statement was 'about defining the feeling so that the reaction can be shaped and the consequences managed' (Blair, 2010: 566). A way of ensuring that the audience was presented with the desired message was to project the relations between the happenings and doings construed within the clauses in a manner which best suited Blair's goal of managing the audience's response.

In order to investigate how speakers perform texture I recruited eleven readers, all native English speaking university students at Cardiff University, ranging from final year undergraduates, to MA and PhD students. I recorded their reading of Blair's statement in one of the university's sound studios. These readings are compared with Blair's original reading in this paper. To ensure that the punctuation and orthographic layout of Blair's statement did not unduly influence the eleven readers I removed all punctuation marks, capital letters, except where they denoted proper nouns or the personal pronoun *I*, and set out the text without any indentation or spacing between paragraphs. The readers were given the script two days prior to recording and asked to fill out a short questionnaire concerning their views on the war on terror and the UK government. This was done to ensure that the readers thought about the meaning potential realized by the lexicogrammatical choices within the text. It was noticeable that many of the readers brought their own marked-up copies of the speech to the recording which they used as an aid to their readings.

Table 5.1 illustrates that within the confines of the meaning potential allowed by the text the speakers realized differing Tonality choices, with all eleven readers segmenting the text into fewer tone units than Blair did. Example (1) illustrates how the speakers, including Blair, presented the circumstantial elements *at the moment* which closed off the first orthographic paragraph. Speakers, depending on their perception of the speech's meaning potential could potentially place the circumstantial elements into its own tone unit, into the tail of the preceding tone unit or into the pre-head or head of the following tone unit.

Table 5.1 Speaker and speech data.

<i>Name of speaker</i>	<i>Gender</i>	<i>Duration of speec (seconds)</i>	<i>Number of tone units</i>
Tony Blair	male	198.13	95
CB1	male	135.67	92
SB2	male	120.94	92
CD3	female	136.53	89
MD4	female	164.01	79
ME5	female	118.75	84
CG6	male	118.37	86
TJ7	male	138.31	81
HM8	male	106.76	75
FR9	female	115.61	67
NS10	female	116.04	80
RT11	female	122.87	78

- (1) CONTEXT: and I will simply try and tell you the information as best I can **at the moment**. It is reasonably clear that there have been a series of terrorist attacks in London.

Tonic independent tone unit²

|| at the \Moment || MD4

|| at the \Moment|| ME5

||at the \Moment|| CG6

||at the \↓Moment|| TJ7

|| at the \↓Moment|| HM8

||at the /↑Moment|| NS10

||at the \↓MoMent|| TR11

Tonic with preceding material

||as ... as BEST i can at the \↓Moment|| FR9

Non tonic in tail

|| as BEST i \CAN at the moment || CB1

|| as ... BEST i\↓CAN at the moment || Blair

Non tonic in onset/prehead

|| at the ↑Moment its REASonably \CLEAR|| SB2

||at the moment its ↑REASonably \CLEAR|| CD3

Seven out of the eleven readers, excluding Blair, articulated the circumstantial element as an independent tone unit, and thus as an independent unit of information, (Halliday 1967). They represented the meaning potential of the text as consisting of numerous units of information linked together in various ways and for them *at the moment* was of sufficient interest to be one of these foci of information. One speaker, FR9, realized a choice where the circumstantial element was the information focus in a larger tone unit, while CB1, and Blair himself, projected that the information realized by the circumstantial was recoverable, and so placed the items in the tail of a larger tone unit. By so doing they downgraded its information status to Given. Two speakers, SB2 and CD3, choose to place the circumstantial element in the following tone unit. SB2 placed it in the onset, and therefore as part of the New, while CD3 placed it in the prehead and projected it as Given. CD3, along with SB2, projected the adverbial as part of the second orthographic paragraph while CB1 and Blair projected it as part of the first paragraph. Of the seven speakers who placed the circumstantial into an independent tone unit, one, NS10, projected it as tone unit initial in the second orthographic paragraph.

5.3 Paratones

It is well recognized that speakers in pre-planned or pre-scripted genres such as news reading, audio book reading, anecdotes and bible reading, may mark the beginning of a new topic by resetting the pitch level of the initial onset syllable, (Tench, 1996: 28; Wichmann, 2000: 29). Onset syllables may be pitched as High, Mid or Low. The paragraph is closed by a fall on the final tone unit, which is the lowest reached in the entire unit. Finally there is likely to be a longer than usual pause until the commencement of the following tone unit (Brazil, 1997; Brown *et al.*, 1980; Esser, 1988; Tench, 1996; Wichmann, 2000).

After the closure of a paratone speakers have three options: they can reset their onset pitch level to high to signal maximum disjunction; reset it to mid to signal less disjunction or they can produce a following tone unit with a low onset. The options are outlined in Figure 5.1.

The choice of a high onset projects the introduction of a topic, which is contrary to the previously created discourse expectations. A mid onset signals the introduction of a topic which adds to the previously created discourse expectations, while a low onset projects that the following topic

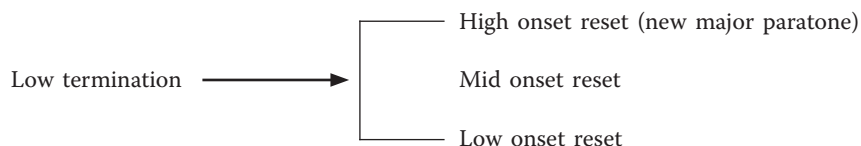


Figure 5.1 Choices available after the closure of a paratone.

is equivalent to the previously created discourse expectations (O'Grady, 2010: 28). Mid and low onsets immediately following a low termination and a significant pause project the introduction of dependent minor paratones which expand the prior paratone in a manner analogous to the relationship between an independent clause followed by a dependent clause.

Speakers may also choose to reset their pitch level following a pause to high or low after a previous mid termination or maintain their pitch level as mid (Figure 5.2).

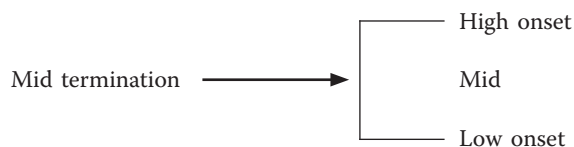


Figure 5.2 Choices available within a paratone.

If a speaker maintains the mid pitch setting they project that they are adding information to the previously created contextual expectations. However, if they choose either a high onset or a low onset they disrupt the previously created contextual expectations by signalling that the following meaning is either unexpected or equivalent. A high or low onset immediately following a mid termination and a longer than expected pause signals the boundary between two minor paratones which together form into a major paratone: for a slightly different view, see Tench (1990: 296–7).

Appendix 2 presents the correspondence between the speakers' projected paratone structure and the orthographic paragraph structure. None of the speakers, including Blair himself, projected a paratone structure which corresponded identically with the orthographic paragraph structure. All of the speakers produced major paratones coterminous with text which belonged to more than one written paragraph. Five of the speakers, not including Blair himself, produced minor paratones which contained text from more than one written paragraph. Example (2) illustrates how Blair's third paratone ran across two written paragraphs with the start of minor paratone {3.2} coinciding with the beginning of orthographic paragraph (C).

- (2) || {3}there are obvi-↑OUSly || ca\SUALties || both \PEOPLE || that have /DIED || and people SERiously\INJURED || <pause> {3.1}and our ↓THOUGHTS and PRAYers of \COURSE are with || the \↑VICtims || and their \FAMilies || <pause> {3.2} its my in\TENTion to || LEAVE the g\EIGHT || within the next COUPLE of \HOURS || and go DOWN to \LONdon || ...

Esser (1988: 26, 29) cautions that those who make their living through oral renditions of scripted material are more sensitive to the communicative value produced by high onsets and low terminations. Accordingly he argues that practised speakers may be far more successful at articulating the paragraph structure of a written text. There is some partial support for this view in Table 5.2. In Table 5.2 major paratones are notated by

Table 5.2 Written versus spoken paragraph structure.

Para	Clause	Blair	CB	SB	CD	MD	ME	CG	TJ	HM	FR	NS	RT
			1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
A	1	1.1	1.1,	1.2	1 to	1 to	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1	1	1.1	1
		&	1.2	& 3	2.3	2.2	to	to	&	to	to	to	to
B	2 & 3	1.2	...		...	...	1.3	1.3	1.2	1.3	2.2	2.1	2.2
							...	...				...	
C	4	2 to	...	4	2.4	2.3	...	...	2	2	3	...	3
		3.1	1.2	&	to	&	1.3	1.3	to		to	2.1	&
D	5 & 6	...	1.3	5.1,	4	2.4	&	to	4		4.2	...	4
		&	2.1	5.2			2	1.6					
E	7, 8 & 9	2.1	...										
		3.2	2.2	6.1	5.1	3.1	3.1	2.1	5.1	3.1	5	...	5.1
F	10 & 11	&	...	...	&	to	...	...	to	to	to	2.1	...
		2.3			5.2	3.4			5.4	3.2	6.1	to	...
G	12 & 13					...			...		...	2.2	...
												...	...
H	14 & 15	4,	3	6.2	6.1,	3.5	...	2.2	5.5	4.1	6.2	...	5.2
		5.1	to	&	6.2	to	3.1	to	&	to	to	2.2	to
I	16 & 17	&	4.2	7.1	& 7	4.3	to	3	6.1	5.2	6.5	to	6.1
		5.2	...	to		...	4.2		to		...	2.5	...
J	18 & 19			7.4	to		...		6.3			...	
				...	8.2				...				
K	20 & 21	6 &	4.3	7.5	9.1	4.4	...	4.1	...	6.1	...	2.6	6.2
		7	...	to	to	to	4.2	to	6.3	to	6.5	to	to
L	22 & 23			9	9.3	5.1	to	4.3		7.1	to	2.7	6.4
				...	...	...	4.6	...		...	7.1	...	...
M	24 & 25						...				...		
N	26 & 27	8 &	4.4	...	9.4	5.2	...	4.4	7	...	...	...	...
		9	&	9 &	& 6	4.6	4.6			7.1	7.1	2.7	...
O	28 & 29		4.5	10			& 5			to	to	to	6.4
										7.2	7.2	2.8	& 7

integers, for example 1, minor paratones by decimal points, for example, 1.1. (The numbers in Tables 5.2 to 5.4 refer to the clause structure of the text – see Appendix 3. Appendix 2 presents the text marked up in stages.) The notation ‘...’ indicates that a major paratone continued across an orthographic paragraph boundary.

Blair proved to be more sensitive to orthographic paragraphs than the other readers. He produced five high keys to signal the commencement of a new written paragraph. He only failed to mark the opening of paragraph C through a sequencing of low termination, significant pause and high onset reset. The average for the other readers was 3.27 high keys, indicating that they marked half of the orthographic paragraph commencements by projecting the beginning of a major paratone. One reader, HM8, however, – see Table 5.2 – proved to be as sensitive as Blair in marking the beginning of new orthographic paragraphs. He projected a major paratone boundary to signal all orthographic paragraph openings except that of paragraph F.

All the speakers, however, projected a paratone structure, which, with two exceptions, ME5 and NS10, illustrated their recognition of the change in topic signalled in writing by paragraph structure. All readers predictably marked the opening of the text with a high onset. Only three of the eleven readers, CB1, ME5 and NS10, did not mark the beginning of paragraph B with a major or minor paratone boundary. Only NS10 did not mark the beginning of paragraph C with a major or minor paratone boundary. Two readers, ME5 and NS10, did not mark the beginning of paragraph D with a major or minor paratone boundary. ME5 and FR9 did not mark the beginning of paragraph E with a major or minor paratone boundary. In comparison seven of the readers did not mark the beginning of paragraph F with a major or minor paratone boundary. A possible reason for this will be advanced below. In conclusion it can be seen that readers faced with an unpunctuated and non-lineated text were for the most part capable of projecting a texture where topic shifts were projected as either new paratones or new minor paratones.

Blair’s statement was designed to manage the expectations of the TV audience and control their reaction to the bombing. His statement clearly belongs to the field of politics but it is far more difficult to know which genre³ it belongs to. It seems to combine elements of a report stating what happened, a justification explaining why it happened and a hortation proclaiming what must happen. Indeed it is not entirely clear that Blair’s statement fits into any recognizable genre. However, as Table 5.3 indicates, the statement is formed out of recognizable stages though ones that are somewhat ad hoc.

It is immediately noticeable that the written paragraph structure, presented in Table 5.4, is not entirely in accord with the stages contained in the text. Paragraph A realizes the abstract in clause 1.1 by setting the scene for the speech. It prefigures what the statement will be about. Clauses 1.2 to 1.4 move the narrative along by orientating the hearer. These clauses inform the audience of the setting for the speech: Blair is unable to provide full details of what occurred and seeks the audience's recognition of this fact. Paragraph B realizes the incident: the audience is informed of what happened, namely the bombing in London, and then informed again of the consequences of the bombing, namely the fatalities and casualties. Paragraph C realizes a repercussion of the incident, the forced change to Blair's plans. Paragraph D realizes not only an interpretation of the repercussion by emphasizing that Blair's absence will not impact upon the working of the G8 but also subsequently an orientation to the stance of his fellow leaders. Paragraph E contains four separate stages of the text structure. There is an initial evaluation of the consequences of the act. This is followed by a restating of the incident, which appears to function as the basis for the immediately following thesis that the G8 was the target for the bombing. The text, however immediately defers consideration of the thesis until an unspecified later date.⁴ Paragraph F realizes the argument that terrorism is futile in two stages. First it realizes the grounds— namely that the terrorists must be made aware of 'our determination to protect our values', and second it realizes the conclusion that because of 'our determination' the terrorist will never succeed.

Table 5.3 Text phases and orthographic paragraphs.

<i>Paragraph</i>	<i>Text phases</i>
A	Abstract (1.1), 1st orientation (1.2) – (1.4)
B	Incident (2) & (3)
C	Repercussions (4)
D	Interpretation (5), orientation (6)
E	Evaluation (7), incident repeat (8.1), thesis (8.2), deferral (9)
F	Argument/grounds (10), argument/conclusions (11)

Tables 5.2 and 5.4 illustrate that if minor paratones are considered to project discrete stages, then all of the readers and Blair produced more paratones than there were orthographic paragraphs. This indicates that they projected a texture richer than a string of six related unfolding topics. Table 5.4 sets out the correlation between the text stages and the speakers' projected paratone structure

134 *Choice in Language*

Table 5.4 Text stages and paratone structure.

Stages	Clause	Blair	CB	SB	CD	MD	ME	CG	TJ	HM	FR	NS	RT
			1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
Abstract	1.1	1.1	1.1	1	1	1	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1	1	1.1	1
Orientation 1		...	...				...	...	...	...		...	
	1.2	1.2	...	2,	2.1	2.1	1.2	1.2	1.2	1.2	2.1	1.2	2.1
	to		1.1	3	to	to	to	to		to	to	to	to
	1.4		&	&	2.3	2.2	1.3	1.3		1.3	2.2	1.3	2.3
Incident			1.2	4	...	...	...						
			...										
	2	2	1.3,	5.1	2.4,	2.3	1.4	1.4	2	2	3	2.1	3
	&	&	1.4	to	3		&	to	to		&	...	&
Repercussions													
	3	3.1	&	5.2	&		2	1.6	4		4.1		4
		...	2.1		4						to		
Interpretation			...								4.2		
	4	...	2.2	6.1	5.1	3.1	3.1	2.1	5.1	3.1	5	2.2	5.1
		3.1	2.3	...	5.2	to	...	...	to	3.2	&	...	...
Orientation 2			3.2			3.3			5.2		6.1		
						...			...		...		
	5	4	3	6.2	6.1	3.4	...	...	5.3	4.1	...	2.3	5.2
				&	6.2	&	3.1	2.1	...	4.2	6.1	...	...
Evaluation				7.1	7	4.1	3.2	2.2			to		
				7.2		...					6.3		
			...								...		
	6	5.1	4.1	7.3	8.1	4.2	4.1	3	5.4	5.1	6.4	2.4	5.2
Incident repeat		5.2	to	7.4	8.2	4.3	4.2		...	5.2	...	...	...
			4.2	...		...	...						
	7	6	4.3	7.5	9.1	4.4	4.3	4.1	5.5	6.1	6.5	2.5	...
Thesis			...	7.6	...	...	4.4	...		...	...	...	5.2
							...						&
													6.1
													...
Deferral													6.2
	8.1	7	...	8.1	9.2	4.5	4.5	4.2	6.1	6.2	7.1	2.6	6.2
		...	4.3	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...
			...										
Argument/ grounds													
	8.2	...	8.2	...	...	...	...	...	6.2	...	...	...	6.3
		7	4.3	9.2	4.5	4.5	4.2	...	6.2	7.1	2.6	...	...
Argument/ conclusions		...	...	...					...	...	...		
	9	...	...	9	9.3	5.1	4.6	4.3	6.3	7.1	...	...	6.4
		7	4.3	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	7.1	2.6	...
Argument/ conclusions			...								...	...	
	10	8	4.4	...	9.4	5.2	...	...	...	...	...	2.7	...
			...	9	...	...	4.6	4.3	6.3	7.1	7.1		6.4
Argument/ conclusions								4.4					
	11	9	4.5	10	9.5	6	5	...	7	7.2	7.2	2.8	7
								4.4					

Table 5.4 illustrates that none of the speakers projected a paratone structure which directly corresponded with the stages of the text. However, the readers' projected paratone structure indicated their awareness of how the various stages of the text contributed to the unfolding of their narrative. All the speakers with the exception of CB1, signalled the end of the abstract and the beginning of the orientation 1 phase by projecting a paratone or minor paratone boundary between the two stages of the text. Blair, along with five of the other readers, notated the transition between abstract, which prefigured what was to come, and the Orientation 1 which grounded the narrative in the context in which it was to be told with a minor paratone boundary indicating that, while separate, the two stages were projected as being linked together. They represented two discrete stages of the text which were themselves separate from the telling which commenced with the incident stage.

All of the readers marked the transition from orientation to incident by projecting a paratone boundary. Blair, along with four other readers, projected a major paratone boundary signalling maximum disjunction from what has gone before. The paratone boundary signalled to the audience to pay attention to the transition from one stage of the text to another.⁵ It is of interest that Blair alone did not project a major or minor paratone boundary between the incident phase and the repercussion phase. In other words, he signalled to the audience that the incident and the repercussions were to be treated by the audience as a single stage in the text. The repercussions, notably the disruption to the working of the G8, were according to Blair an entirely predictable consequence of the terrorist attack.

Only TR11 did not explicitly signal the transition from the factual report realized by the incident and repercussions stages to the interpretation. CB1 and TR11 were the only two readers who did not explicitly mark the shift to the following stage orientation 2. The readers, thus far, appeared to have few difficulties in identifying the stages of the text and in projecting the transitions. Paragraph E however contained four stages, the evaluation, the incident repeat, the thesis and the deferral. Neither Blair nor any of the other speakers projected all these stages as independent paratones. Blair, himself, projected a paratone structure where the evaluation alone was signalled as a discrete event. None of the other speakers signalled a paratone structure where the evaluation was projected as a major paratone. The effect of Blair's choice was to focus his audience's attention on the timing of the terrorist attack. This choice coupled with his earlier choice not to project the repercussions as a discrete stage in the text projected a meaning subtly different from

that of the other readers. Blair uniquely signalled to his audience a focus on the G8 as the ultimate target of the attack.

All of the readers signalled their recognition that the incident repeat signalled a new stage in the unfolding text by the projection of a minor paratone boundary. However, only three of them, not including Blair, projected the incident repeat as a discrete stage in the text. The others projected that the incident repeat was linked to the thesis. It was the background upon which the thesis was advanced. Blair, unlike the majority of the other speakers projected a paratone structure where the deferral was part of the same textual stage as the thesis and the incident repeat. For him, alone, the thesis was informationally foregrounded.

I noted earlier that many of the readers did not explicitly signal the beginning of paragraph F by projecting a major or minor paratone boundary. This appears to have resulted from these readers' difficulties in incorporating the deferral stage into the structure of the text. Most recognized it as a different stage from the preceding thesis but seemed unsure as to what function it realized in the unfolding of the narrative. Hence, they tended to project it as part of the following stage, argument/grounds. All of the speakers, including Blair, realized the final two stages, arguments/grounds and argument/conclusions, as either two major or minor paratones.

To conclude, it is clear that the speakers' projection of paratone structure showed that they were cognisant of the stages of the text when articulating the text. However, we have seen that Blair's projection of paratone structure differed in three significant ways. First he projected a context where the repercussions automatically followed from the bombing, a fact we can infer he believed that the bombers were aware of. Second, Blair projected the evaluation as a discrete textual event. By so doing he focused attention on disrupting the G8 as the ultimate target of the terrorists. Finally, by projecting the incident repeat, thesis and deferral stages in a single major paratone he foregrounded his view that the G8 was the terrorist's target.

In short we can see that paratone structure reflects both the formal orthographic paragraph layout of presenting single topics in discrete units and the stages of the text. However, while the relationship is close it is not identical. Speakers are free to project paratone structures which foreground a meaning potential which may not be a meaning potential foregrounded by either the orthographic layout or the lexicogrammar.

5.4 Spoken taxis

Prior to an extended discussion of how speakers use intonation to project logico-semantic meaning it is first necessary to briefly sketch how clausal tactic relations are signalled by the lexicogrammar. Clause and clause like elements may be linked together in the following ways. First there may be no tactic relation signalled by the lexicogrammar as between clause 9 and clause complex 10 (see Appendix 3). Secondly potentially independent clauses may be linked paratactically: each clause or clause-like element has the same status, for example, clauses 1.1, 1.2, 1.3 and 1.4. Alternatively the clause or clause-like elements may be linked hypotactically with the clauses being projected as having an unequal status, as in clause complex 7 where the α clause is projected as the head of the clause complex. The other elements are dependent on the clause, which operates as the head of the clause complex.

Clauses which are linked together enter into two types of semantic relations: expansion and projection. The system of expansion develops the experiential meaning of a clause through Elaboration (signified by =) which is a relation of restatement; Extension (signified by +) which is a relation of addition and Enhancement (signified by x) which is a relation of modification of time, space, means, cause condition and so on, (see Eggins 2004: 278–9). The system of Projection is in Eggins's words 'the logio-semantics of quoting and reporting speech or thoughts' (*ibid.*: 271). In the statement the sole example of projection is found in Clause 1.2.

The statement itself comprises nine clause complexes and two clause simplexes. Including embedded clauses there are 52 clauses in all. Blair added the minor clause *thank you* to the statements and this element was included in the version given to the eleven other speakers to read. It is immediately noticeable that many of the clauses are quite long, as is to be expected from pre-planned discourse, and hence not likely to be produced in single tone units. Unsurprisingly all of the speakers produced far more than 53 tone units with Blair himself producing 96 (see Table 5.1). The logico-semantic relations within the first clause complexes are detailed below following Eggins (2004) and Halliday and Matthiessen (2004).

Clause complex 1 consists of four paratactic clauses. All of the clauses are independent pieces of information which in the absence of the conjunction *and* could have stood on their own. Yet the text instantiates a meaning where clauses 1.2, 1.3 and 1.4 extend the meaning realized within clause 1.1. Clause 1.2, itself, consists of a projecting clause which consists of two clausal elements (see Halliday and Matthiessen, 2004: 444).

The projected idea *you understand ...* is an enhancement of the *hope*: it qualifies it first by reference to a condition and secondly by reference to a specific time. It is worth noting that there are four rankshifted clauses, found within the first clause complex which themselves modify nominal, verbal and adverbial elements operating within the clauses. In Clause 1.1 the rankshifted clause elaborates the previous nominal element *events* by clarifying exactly where the event occurred.

The orthographic version of the text subsequently published on the government website was broken down into six written paragraphs. Table 5.5 shows the relationship between the clause structure and the paratone structure.

Table 5.5 The relation between paragraphs and clause complexes/simplexes.

<i>Paragraphs</i>	<i>Clause complexes/simplexes</i>
A	1
B	2+3
C	4
D	5+6
E	7+8+9
F	10X11

It can be seen that paragraphs B, D and E are formed out of two or more independent and equal clause complexes which exist in a logico-semantic relationship of extension. Speakers though, as we have seen above, project the topical and episode character of the narrative they are telling not in paragraphs or clauses but in paratones and tone units. As noted, to date little work has been done exploring how tone choice projects logico-semantic meaning with the exception of Halliday and Matthiessen (2004: 482–5), Halliday (2005: 291–2) and Halliday and Greaves (2008: 130–35) who propose the following unmarked relationship between tone sequencing and taxis.

(3) Tactic relations	Tone sequencing
Two unrelated clauses	Tone sequence Fall ^ Fall
One paratactic clause complex	Tone Sequence Rise ^ Fall
One hypotactic clause complex	a ^ b = Fall ^ Fall-Rise or b ^ a = Fall-Rise ^ Fall
One independent clause	Fall
Tone Concord expansion	Tone repetition
Elements identical in kind	e.g. Fall ^ Fall
Projection (idea)	A single unit

Thus, if all things proved to be equal we would expect to find the end of a major clausal unit marked by a fall signalling the closure of a discrete

unit. Within a clause complex the boundary between paratactic clauses should be signalled by a rise while the boundary at the end of the entire unit should coincide with a fall. However, if the paratactic clauses are elaborations we would expect tone repetition. In a two clause paratactic complex the sequence is predicted to be a rise followed by a fall while in a three or more clause paratactic complex the sequence is predicted to be a series of rises followed by a final fall. The boundary between a dependent clause and a following independent clause is noted by a fall-rise while if the hypotactic clause complex culminates in a dependent clause it is similarly notated by a fall-rise. Smith (2008: 124) notes that rises have the logical function of parataxis while fall-rises have the logical function of hypotaxis.

Other scholars who focus on the relationship between tone selection and the status of information, such as Tench (1990: 219–24, 1996: 80–86), and Crystal (1969: 244ff.), argue that the status of information projected by tone selection is as follows:

(4) Tone sequence	Informational value
Fall ^ Fall	Two pieces of major information
Rise ^ Fall	Incomplete (major) ^ Major information
Fall ^ Rise	Major ^ Minor information
Fall-rise ^ Fall	Theme highlighting ^ Major information
Any tone ^ Fall-rise	Major information ^ Implication

Tench notes that rises either indicating major incomplete information or minor information co-occur on circumstantial elements which function to suggest a limitation on the information projected by the main clause (see also Cruttenden, 1997: 95). Thus, if a clause containing a final circumstantial element was realized by more than one tone unit, the tone which projects dependency across clauses is not the final rise but the tone which corresponds to the major information within the clause. If the final tone is a fall it completes the information. My constructed example (5a–5c) illustrates.

- (5a) || it is my intention to leave the \G8 || within the next couple of /HOURS ||
Major information Minor information pause
- (5b) || it is my intention to leave the /G8 || within the next couple of \HOURS ||
Major incomplete information Major complete information pause
- (5c) || it is my intention to leave the /G8 || within the next couple of /HOURS ||
Major incomplete information Minor information pause

The pause at the end of the examples projects disjunction and signals the start of a new unit. The combination of pause and tone selection projects (5a) and (5b) as independent units. They are not projected as being

dependent on any following unit. (5c), however projects a context where the unit is projected intonationally as being dependent on a following unit. The proposition contained within the clause can only be evaluated in the light of following information (see Pierrehumbert and Hirschberg, 1990; Ladd, 2008). Thus, we could predict that if the projection of information is congruent with the tactic relations established by the lexicogrammar, an independent clause must contain a falling tone though the falling tone may not necessarily be clause final. Dependent clauses are predicted to contain non-falling tones indicating their informational incompleteness.

Table 5.6 shows the percentage of tone chosen by all the speakers. For all speakers the fall was the most common choice, ranging from 47.61 per cent to 79.01 per cent of all tones. For some speakers the rise is the second most common tone choice, ranging from 7.69 per cent to 21.73 per cent, but for others the fall-rise is the second most common choice, ranging from 2.46 per cent to 25.3 per cent. The level and the rise-fall are the least common choices. In short it is clear that the speakers choose different tone compositions while articulating the same text.

The tone composition chosen by Blair differed from that of the other speakers in three ways. Unlike the other readers, with the exception of RT11, he did not select any rise-fall tones. He produced the highest number of level tones and, with the sole exception of TJ7, produced the fewest number of fall-rise tones. A rise-fall tone signals the strength of a speaker's commitment to what he/she is saying. Brazil (1997: 97) describes it as projecting that the speaker has at the moment of speaking registered the significance of his utterance. It is clear why this would not be a meaning which Blair, who very much needed to appear to be in charge of the situation, would have wanted to convey in a response to a terrorist bombing.

Level tone projects speaker disengagement from the communicative context. Speakers may disengage because of momentary processing problems in assembling their message or because the words they are

Table 5.6 The readers' selections of tones in percentages.

Tone unit	Blair	CB1	SB2	CD3	MD4	ME5	CG6	TJ7	HM8	FR9	NS10	RT11
\	67.36	59.78	67.39	65.16	58.22	47.61	70.93	79.01	64	59.7	63.75	71.79
/	14.73	21.73	14.13	14.6	11.39	21.42	10.46	13.58	13.33	8.95	11.25	7.69
–	9.47	1.08	1.08	2.24	2.53	7.14	2.32	2.46	2.66	5.97	1.25	6.42
∨	8.42	15.21	16.30	14.6	25.31	21.42	13.95	2.46	18.66	23.88	20	14.10
∧	0	2.1	1.08	3.37	2.53	2.38	2.32	2.46	1.33	1.49	3.75	0

uttering are so routine that they do not need to take account of their informational status (Brazil, 1997; Tench, 1997). For present purposes it is sufficient to note that a level tone does not project that the speaker has articulated a piece of major information; the choice of level tone signals dependence and not independence (Crystal, 1975: 35). The paucity of fall-rise tones in Blair's articulation is of interest in that we would expect more fall-rises, all things being equal, to be present in a text which contains hypotactic clauses. This is a point, which will be revisited in the following section.

Prior to examining tone sequences in the actual data, however, it is necessary to establish that the sequencing of tones was different from what we could expect were the tones sequenced solely on the basis of chance, or, in other words, if we assumed that there was no meaning projected by the position of a tone in an utterance (see O'Grady, 2010 and, for a contrasting view, Brazil, 1997). El Menoufy (1969: 426 ff.), in an investigation of around 3000 tone units, found that there is a tendency for pairs of tones to co-occur more or less frequently than chance, or, in other words, tone sequencing was motivated in her data. Table 5.7 illustrates the tone sequencing found within the 14 minor paratones in Blair's articulation of the text. The bracketed numbers represent the number of tones which we would expect to find had the sequencing of tones been no more than an epiphenomenal effect. The * diacritic is used to indicate a paired sequence of tones which is much more or much less than chance.

Table 5.7 The sequencing of tones in Blair's speech.

[illegible]

The first column # illustrates that the number of falling tones following silence (notated by #) is slightly more than chance. There are only half the number of rises following silence than a chance distribution would have predicted. While the number of falls, rises and fall-rises following falls is very similar to a chance distribution, the number of level tones and silences following falls differs from a chance distribution. The number of falling tones immediately followed by silence in Blair's articulation is 50 per cent more than a chance distribution and seems to be motivated by Blair's decision to choose final falling tones to signal completion. There are more falls following rises and fewer rises following rises than would be expected. No levels followed by silence were found in Blair's articulation. The number of fall-rises following levels is three times more than expected. The distribution of tones following fall-rises differs from what chance would lead us to expect. There are around three times as many rises following fall-rises than we would expect. Blair did not produce any final fall-rises contrary to expectations. We can conclude by saying that not only are Blair's tone selections motivated but the sequence of tones is similarly motivated.

5.5 Tone sequences

This section examines the information flow within the text. It chiefly focuses on clause complex 1 (see example (6)) as it is both the opening of the text and the longest clause complex found in the text. It is formed out of four paratactic nexuses, each of which contains an embedded clause. The lexicogrammar construes the following logico-semantic relationships: the initial clause construes a doing with an embedded elaboration signalling the equivalence or rewording of the doing construed in the non-embedded part of the clause. The presence of the conjunctive element signals a paratactic link to the following clause which construes a mental activity; the projection of a 'hope'. The projection is linked paratactically by the conjunctive element to a relational process which is also linked by the same conjunction to a fourth clause. Thus, the lexicogrammar projects four clauses which could have stood alone as being connected and of being of equal status. Intonationally we might therefore expect a speaker to signal the relationship between the paratactic clauses through the selection of rises projecting that the proposition contained within the clause is not to be considered in isolation from what is to follow. However, as previously noted, all of the paratactic clauses are far too long to be articulated within

a single tone unit and, thus, we would expect the paratactic clauses to be spoken in a manner which signals the flow of information within each independent clause. Thus, the heads of the clauses should tend to be marked as more informationally significant and be projected by falls. As example (6) illustrates more than one systemic option would appear to be available to the speaker at certain points within the text.

- (6) I am just going to make a short statement to you on the terrible events
FALL FALL/RISE/FALL-RISE
 "[[that have happened in London earlier today]],
RISE
 +2 α and I hope
FALL
 +xβ you understand
FALL
 +xγ that at the present time we are still trying to establish
FALL
 +[[[exactly γ1 what has happened,]]
FALL-RISE RISE
 +3 and there is a limit "[[to what information I can give you]],
FALL FALL RISE
 +4 1 and I will simply try and tell you the information as best
FALL
 +[[[I can at the moment]],
RISE

In clause 1 we would expect a speaker to produce a falling tone to correspond with the head of the clause.⁷ The circumstantial element, which modifies what the statement will be about, can be projected in speech as a piece of major information equal to the statement through the choice of a fall. A rise conversely would project that the circumstantial element limits content of the statement while a fall-rise would project an implication shared by speaker and audience. As the embedded clause is downgraded informationally we would expect it to be articulated with a rise. In the second clause a speaker would be expected to produce a sequence of falls on the projecting clause signalling the speaker's action and on the head of the projected clause. The embedded clause is expected to be articulated with a rise. Similarly in clauses 3 and 4 we would expect the speaker to project the downgraded informational status of the embedded clauses with a rise.

Table 5.8 shows the tone choices and the number of paratones each speaker selected when articulating clause complex 1. The first thing to note is that Blair was one of only two readers whose intonation projects clause complex 1 as a single unified semantic unit. He, however, projected

the clause complex as comprising two parts while the other reader projected it as comprising three parts. The other readers did not in their readings project the clause complex as a single semantic unit – three of them CB1, ME5 and CG7 projected the clause complex as being part of a larger semantic unit while the remaining readers projected the clause complex as being divisible into smaller semantic units, for example SB2 who subdivided the clause complex into three paratones. Three other readers divided the clause complex into two semantic units. The symbol + indicates that the particular paratone/minor paratone included material from a following clause complex.

Table 5.8 Number of tones and paratones in clause complex1.

	\	/	–	\/	/\	Total	Paratones	Minor paratones
Blair	7	4	2	3	0	16	1	2
CB1	9	2	1	2	1	15	0	2
SB2	8	1	0	3	0	12	3	4
CD3	9	0	1	2	0	13	1+	3
MD4	9	2	0	2	0	13	2+	3
ME5	6	2	1	3	0	12	0	3
CG6	8	1	1	4	1	15	0	1+
TJ7	11	1	0	0	0	12	2	3
HM8	9	3	0	1	0	13	1	3
FR9	6	1	1	4	0	12	2	3
NS10	11	2	2	0	0	15	1+	3+
RT11	8	0	2	2	0	12	2	4

Example 7 presents Blair's articulation of clause complex 1. The numbers in brackets label paratones and minor paratones.

- (7) ||{1.1} i am just going to MAKE a –SHORT|| \STATEment|| to you on the
Major/incomplete Major
\TERRible events || that have /HAPPened|| in \LONdon||EARlier /↓TOday||
Major/implication Minor Major Minor
|| {1.2} and i HOPE you under\STAND|| that at the ↑PREsent \TIME|| we are
Theme highlighting Major/complete
|| STILL TRYing to e\STABlish exactly ||what has \HAPpened||
Major implication Major
|| and theres a /LIMit|| to WHAT inforMAtion||i can ↑/GIVE you ||
Major/incomplete Major Minor
|| and i'll simply TRY and \TELL you || the in–FORMAtion as || as ... BEST i
Major Major/incomplete
↓\CAN at the moment ||
Major/complete

If we look at Blair's reading we can see that the four clauses are predictably examples of marked tonality. In Blair's reading the minor paratone boundary at the end of clause 1 projects that it is partially segmented off from the remainder of the clause complex. He packages the flow of information as follows: the heart of the clause, the actor, and process are presented in two information units with the first indicating incomplete major information and the second major information. The following circumstance is presented as an implication. By so doing Blair communicates an unspoken implication about the terrible events to his audience, which they and they alone are projected as being able to infer. The embedded clause is broken down into a series of three tone units with the circumstantial adjunct incongruently presented as major information. This results in the foregrounding of the location of the bombing.

The effect of this reading is to create a flow of information markedly different to that projected by the lexicogrammar. Rather than simply being the first clause (with an embedded clause) in a paratactic sequence Blair packages the information flow of his message as containing four pieces of major information and two pieces of minor information. The presence of the fall-rise in the middle of the sequence is of interest in that it invites the hearer to infer that something does not need to be said about the terrible events.

Only three of the speakers, CB1, CG6 and TJ7 did not articulate a reading which separated the initial clause, which functioned as the abstract of the text, from the remainder of the clause complex. This suggests that the speakers' decisions about how to package the information flow were more influenced by the organization of the text into stages than they were by its formal arrangement into clauses and clause complexes. Blair's articulation of the remaining three clauses, which functioned together as the orientation to the text, was not in full accordance with the predictions set out in example (6). Blair articulated the orientation as predominantly a sequential chain of tone units which were projected as containing major information. Blair articulated two of the embedded clauses with falling tones and consequently he projected them as chunks of major information. The embedded clause in clause 3 was articulated with a rise and projected as limiting the type and amount of information available to the audience.

HM8 is the speaker whose articulation is closest to Blair's. Like Blair he projected the entire clause complex as a single paratone but, unlike Blair, he segmented it into three minor paratones. Like Blair his first minor paratone was coterminous with clause 1 which functioned as the abstract. However, unlike Blair, he placed clauses 2 and 3 into one minor

paratone and separated it from clause 4. HM8's articulation is presented in example (8).

- (8) || {1.1} i am just ↑GOing to make a SHORT \STATEment || to /YOU || on the
Major Minor
TERrible e\VENTS || that have \HAPpened in london || EARlier \↓to\DAY ||
Major Major Major
|| {1.2} and i hope you under\↑STAND || that at the PREsent /TIME || we are
Major Major incomplete
still TRYing to e/STABlish || eXACTly what has \HAPpened ||
Major/incomplete Major
|| and theres a Llimit to what inforMAtion i can \GIVE you ||
Major Implication
||{1.3} will simply ↑TRY and tell you the infor\MAtion || as BEST as i \CAN
||
Major Major
at the \↓MOment ||
Major

The opening clause realized as minor paratone (1.1) contains four pieces of major information. The sole rising tone is used to project the limiting of the audience of the text to the immediate hearers. Clauses 2 and 3 are projected as major information with the information in clause 3 projecting an implication. Clause 4 articulated as minor paratone (1.3) is realized as a sequence of three tone units which project major information. The other readers similarly did not mark the embedded clausal material as informationally less important. All of them selected at least one falling tone coterminous with the embedded elements. They presented the initial clause complex as a sequence of chiefly major chunks of information with the occasional piece of minor information. Fall-rises were used to project contextually bound implications.

The speakers, including Blair, projected a flow of information which was not in accord with the expectations set out in example 6. Within the remaining eight clause nexuses Blair and the other speakers did not explicitly re-enforce syntactic dependence through their tone choices. For instance as examples (9) to (11) show, throughout the remainder of the text the speakers consistently did not project the informational downgrading of embedded elements through the selection of a rise.

- (9) It is reasonably clear ^x[[that there have been a series of terrorist attacks in London]].
 || it's reaso[↑]NABly \CLEAR|| that there have been a ... a Series of ter\ RORist attacks|| in \↓LONdon|| Blair

|| it's rea[↑]SONably /CLEAR|| that there have been a SERIES of TErrorist
 at\TACKS|| in \LONdon|| CB1
 || at the MOMent it's REASONably \CLEAR|| that there have been -A|| a
 SERIES of TErrorist at\TACKS|| in \↓LONdon||SB2
 || at the moment it's [↑]REASONably \CLEAR|| that there have been a [↑]Series
 of \TErrorist attacks|| in \↓LONdon||CD3
 ||{2.3} it's [↑]REASONably \CLEAR|| that there have been a ... a SERIES of \
 TErrorist attacks || in \LONdon || MD4
 || {1.4} it's [↑]REASONably \CLEAR|| that there have been a ... || a SERIES of
 TErrorist\A\tacks in london||ME5
 || {1.4} it's REASONably \CLEAR|| that there have been a SERIES of \TErrorist
 attacks|| in \LONdon||CG6
 || it's [↑]REASONably \CLEAR|| that there have been a SERIES of \TErrorist
 attacks || in /↓LONdon||TJ7
 || it's [↑]REASONably \CLEAR|| that there have been a SERIES of TErrorist
 attacks in \LONdon||HM8
 || it's [↑]REASONably \CLEAR|| that there have been a seri of ... a SERIES
 of TErrorist atTACKS in \↓LONdon||FR9
 || at the /MOMent|| its REASONably \CLEAR|| that there have been a -
 SERIES|| of TErrorist atTACKS in \LONdon||NS10
 || it's[↑]REASONably \CLEAR|| that there have been a SERIES of TErrorist
 at\TACKS|| in \↓LONdon||TR11

Five speakers including Blair articulated the embedded element as a sequence of two tone units containing falling tones or as two pieces of major information. Other readers, such as CD3, produced a sequence of a falling tone followed by a fall-rise and projected an unspoken implication about the location of the bombing. TJ7 alone projected the location of the bombing as minor information which limited the location and perhaps the effect of the terrorist attack.⁸

- (10) **and the Ministers** =[[that have been dealing with this,]]
 ||and the minISters that have been \↓DEALing|| with /THIS|| Blair
 ||[↑]AND the \MINisters|| that have been DEALing with \↓THIS|| CB1
 ||and the \MINisters|| that have been DEALing with \↓THIS|| SB2
 ||and the \MINisters|| that have been \DEALing with this|| CD3
 ||and the \MINisters|| that have been DEALing with \↓THIS|| MD4
 ||and the \MINisters|| that have been \DEALing with this|| ME5
 ||and the \MINisters|| that have been \DEALing with this|| CG6
 ||and the MINisters that have been \↓DEALing with this|| TJ7
 ||and the \MINisters|| that HAVE been DEALing with /THIS|| HM8
 ||and the \↓MINisters|| that HAVE been \↓DEALing with this || FR9
 ||and the \MINisters|| that have been \DEALing with this|| NS10
 ||and the min\ISters|| that have been \DEALing with this|| TR11

In example (10) as in (9) the majority of the speakers projected the informationally downgraded post modifying element as major information through the selection of a falling tone or as major information with an implication through the selection of a fall-rise. The two exceptions are Blair and HM8. Blair projects the elements *with this* as limiting the actions of the ministers while HM8, in congruence with the grammar, projects the rankshifted clause as less significant informationally.

11 and reach the conclusions "[which we were going to reach.]

||and REACH the con/CLUSions|| WHICH we were GOing to \↓REACH||Blair
 ||and REACH the con/CLUSions|| which we were GOing to \↓REACH||CB1
 ||and REACH the con/CLUSions|| that we were ↓GOing to \REACH||SB2
 ||and↑REACH the con/CLUSions|| WHICH we were GOing to \↓REACH||CD3
 ||and REACH the con/CLUSions|| which we were GOing to \REACH||MD4
 ||and REACH the con/CLUSions||which we were going to \↓REACH||ME5
 || and REACH the con/CLUSions|| which we were GOing to \↓REACH||CG6
 ||and REACH the con/CLUSions which we were going to reach|| TJ7
 ||and REACH the con/CLUSions|| which we were GOing to \↓REACH||HM8
 ||and REACH the con/CLUSions|| which we were \GOing to reach || FR9
 ||and↑REACH the con/CLUSions|| which we were \GOing to reach|| NS10
 ||and REACH the con/CLUSions|| WHICH we were \GOing to reach|| TR11

In (11) all the speakers bar TJ7 placed the post modifying embedded clause into its own tone unit and projected it either as a piece of major information or as piece of major information to which a contextually bound implication is attached. TJ7 did not place the rank shifted clause into its own tone unit. Rather he chose to project it in post tonic position and, by so doing, projected that the post modified elements were Given and thus, informationally downgraded.

In the text studied the speakers selected tone to project the information status of tone units. They tended to project their messages as a series of chunks of major information interspersed with contextually bound implications projected by fall-rises. Non final rises and level tones projected major though not compete information. Final rises modified or limited the previous information. In short the speakers' tone choices did not appear to be overly influenced by the tactic relations signalled by the lexicogrammar but focused more on managing their hearers' discourse expectations through the signalling of a dependence/independence relation between information units contained within a paratone.

The falling tone was most common tone chosen by all speakers. This may have been because the speakers had no fear of being interrupted and thus, did not need to manage their hearer's contribution to the discourse. Yet, speakers do not construct discourse in isolation. Hearers, through their

presence, influence how speakers manage the flow of information within their discourse. With that in mind the following paragraphs examine the role of non-final rises and level tones in Blair's discourse. In example (12) and in all following examples the tone units under discussion are emboldened.

- (12) ||{1.1} **i am just going to MAKE a –SHORT**||\STATEment|| to you on the \TERrible events|| that have /HAPpened|| in \LONdon||\↓EARlier/Today|| {1.2} and i HOPE you under\STAND|| that at the ↑PREsent\TIME|| we are STILL TRYing to e\STABlish exactly|| what has \HAPPened|| **and theres a /LIMIT**|| to WHAT in\FORMation|| i can ↑/GIVE you|| and i'll simply TRY and \TELL you || **the infor–MAtion as**|| as ... BEST i\↓CAN at the moment ||

It appears that as well as projecting incomplete major information the level tones signalled processing problems or simulated processing problems – see also the initial tone unit of example (13); Blair was focusing on assembling his message and not projecting it. The level tone appeared not so much to signal non-completeness but more that the speaker was temporarily disengaged from projecting information as complete or incomplete. Had Blair placed a falling and not a rising tone on limit he would have signalled a point of potential syntactic completion – though at a point which could not have matched any informational expectation of the audience. The fact that there is a limit would have been projected as of equal importance as the content of the limit. However, Blair's choice of a rise signalled that the fact of the limit could not be considered in isolation from the following co-text. The content of the limit was projected as being informationally more salient.

In paratone 3 Blair uses non-final rises to signal non-completeness.

- (13) || {3.1} there are obvi–↑OUSly||ca\SUALties|| both \PEOPle||**that have / DIED**|| and people SEriously\INJURED||

Had he articulated *died* with a fall he would have signalled a possible syntactic completion but one which would have been contrary to the expectations created by the co-text. The rise indicated the beginning of a list; there was more to come. Yet, lists do not have to be articulated through as sequence of rises completed by a fall. Example (14) illustrates.

- (14) || {3.2}and our ↓THOUGHTS and \PRAYers of course are with || the ↑\VICTims|| and their \FAMilies||

Blair articulated *victims* with a high fall and by so doing noted the significance of the tonic item to the unfolding of his message. His audience was invited to focus on the fact that there were *victims*. Accordingly, the normal list like nature of the information flow was disrupted.

In paratone 4 Blair's use of a rising tone on *conclusions* mirrored its placement on *limit* in example (12).

- (15) || {4} it is the↑WILL of \ALL|| the LEADers at the g\EIGHT|| how/
 EVer|| that the \MEETing|| should ... con-TINue|| in my ab\SENCE||
 that we should continue to disCUSS the is\SUES|| that we were going to
 dis\CUSS||and REACH the con/CLUSions|| WHICH we were GOing
 to \↓REACH||

Had Blair placed a fall on *conclusions* he would have signalled a point of possible syntactic though not informational completion. By articulating the rise he signalled that his hearer was to interpret the significance of *conclusions* in the light of the forthcoming informationally more prominent tone unit.

The rise on *meeting* in paratone 6 similarly signalled to the hearers that they needed to focus on the content of the meeting and not on the fact of the meeting. Had Blair articulated *Africa* with a fall he would have sent a signal that he had reached a point of informational as well as syntactic completion. The hearers would have been encouraged to interpret Blair's claim prior to accessing the information contained in the remainder of the paratone. The level tone on *try* projects non-completeness but also signals that Blair is focusing on carefully selecting his words.

- (16) || {6}its par↑TICularly\BARbaric|| that this has \HAPpened|| on a \DAY
 when || PEople are /MEETing|| to -TRY to ||HELP the PROBLEms
 of POVerTy in af/RICA || and the LONG term \PROBems|| of CLimate
 CHANGE in the en\↓VIRonment||

The remaining non-final rises in Blair's text similarly signalled that the information unit could only be interpreted in the light of following tone units. The salience of the following information units was foregrounded.

- (17) || {7.1} just as it is rea↑SONably\CLEAR|| that this is a \TERrorist attack||
 or a \SEries of terrorist at\tacks|| it is also reaSONably\CLEAR|| that it
 -IS|| de\SIGNed||and /AIMed|| to coin\CIDE|| with the \OPENing of
 the geight|| intervening minor paratone {7.2}
 || {8} its im↑PORTant however || that THOSE engaged in \TERrorism||rea/
 LIZE|| that ↑OUR deter\MINation||to deFEND our /VALues|| and OUR
 \↓WAY of life || ...

In conclusion, non-final rises in Blair's texts were used not only to bind a tone unit closely to following tone units but also to cue the hearers that significant information was to follow. Table 5.9 considers the tone choices the eleven other speakers made at the points in the text where Blair produced a non-final rise.

Table 5.9 Eleven readers' tone choices at points where Blair choose a rising tone.

Textwith rise	CB1	SB2	CD3	MD4	ME5	CG6	TJ7	HM8	FR9	NS10	TR11
And there's a limit	/\	\	\	none ⁹	none	/\	/*	none	\	\	none
That have died	/*	\	/*	/*	/*	\	/*	—	/*	\	\
Reach the conclusions	\	/*	\	\	\	\	\	/*	\	\	\
People are meeting	\	\	\	\	\	none	\	\	none	/\	\
Poverty in Africa	\	\	\	\	/*	\	\	\	\	\	\
And aimed	\	/*	/*	\	/*	/*	\	\	none	none	/*
Defend our values	\	\	\	\	\	\	\	\	\	/*	\

Table 5.9 illustrates that the meaning potential explicated by Blair's tone choices were not the ones which most speakers choose to project. In other words, there is no evidence in this data that written text constrains tone choice, though there was a tendency for the other speakers to employ rises to project that some items were part of a not as yet finished list, for example *died* and *aimed*. In example (12) Blair chose not to project *victims* and their families as being separate elements in a list. For him they were two separate independent pieces of information contained within the same paratone. The majority of the speakers projected the same relationship. Three readers projected the elements as a single piece of information. One reader, ME5, projected *victims* as being the first element of a list through her choice of a rise. For her alone the fact of victimhood could only be considered with reference to the families. In conclusion it appears that speakers have a degree of freedom to project the dependence of tone units and that they use this degree of freedom to project their message.

5.6 Conclusion

This chapter has illustrated how speakers chose intonational options in order to make their text 'text'. We have seen that the each reader unified their text through their projection of an individual paratone structure. Yet, each reader's as well as Blair's paratone structure showed an awareness of both how the text had been initially organized into orthographic

paragraphs. All of the speakers produced a paratone structure which demonstrated that they were cognisant of the unfolding of the stages of the text. Yet their projected paragraph structures produced meaning potentials which were not constrained by the formal arrangement of the text. Though we saw that Blair's projected paratone structure differed in a manner which guided the hearers through an 'interpretative' pathway which foregrounded his thesis that disrupting the G8 was the ultimate target of the terrorist attack. We have further seen that the speakers' tone choices were not constrained by the tactic relations signalled by the lexicogrammar. Instead their tone choices focused more on managing their hearers' discourse expectations by signalling the status of a unit information as independent, dependent on a following information unit or limiting a previous information unit.

Notes

1. I would like to thank an anonymous reviewer for valuable suggestions, Tom Bartlett for assistance with the clause structure analysis of the text and various colleagues at CLCR in Cardiff for their thoughtful questions and comments when I presented these ideas to them at a staff research seminar. Thanks also go to my student participants.
2. The initials refer to the identity of the speaker. A key for the intonation conventions is provided in Appendix 1.
3. Following Martin and Rose (2003), genre is defined here as a staged, goal-oriented purposeful activity in which speakers engage as members of a culture.
4. It is unknowable whether or not Blair intended at the time of speaking to return to a more complete discussion of his thesis that the bombing was an attack on the G8. He could have introduced the thesis and 'deferred' discussion of it simply to put the thesis on the table in the hope that his audience would uncritically accept it.
5. Esser's point that only practised readers may make maximum use of the combination of low termination, significant pause and high onset pitch reset is worth reiterating. It may be that the five readers who projected the transition from scene setting realized by the orientation, to the actual telling realized by the incident attempted but failed mark a major paratone boundary. In other words we need to be cautious about ascribing functional differences to major and minor paratones projected by unpractised readers.
6. As a result of rounding up and down the numbers of tones predicted by a chance distribution do not exactly match the number of actual tones found in Blair's articulation of the text.

7. A speaker is, of course, free to place the object *to you* in its own tone unit and select a fall, rise or fall rise on *you*. Similarly example (6) is not to be read as claiming that the speaker does not have freedom to divide the clausal structure prior to the tone into more than a single tone unit. For instance, in clause 1.4 the elements *and I will simply tell you the information as best*, is likely to be articulated as more than a single tone unit and the example simply claims that we would expect a fall to appear somewhere in the unit.
8. An alternate explanation for TJ7's final rise is that the rise projected the communicative function of deferring to the hearer. Rather than telling the audience the location of the bombing he projected the information as something shared between himself and his audience. Such a tone selection functions to develop solidarity as much as it does to project information flow (O'Grady, 2010).
9. MD4 produced the utterance || and theres a Llimit to what information i can \GIVE you||. Hence *limit* was projected as pre-tonic. ME5, HM8 and TR11 similarly produced *limit* as a pre-tonic element. *Meeting* was produced as a pre-tonic element by CG6 and FR7 and *aimed* was by FR9 and NS10.

References

- Blair, T. (2010) *A Journey*. London: Hutchinson.
- Brazil, D. (1997) *The Communicative Value of Intonation in English*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Brown, G., Currie, K. L. and Kenworthy, J. (1980) *Questions of Intonation*. London: Croom Helm.
- Coffin, C. and Derewianka B. (2008) Multimodal layout in school history books: The texturing of historical interpretation. In G. Forey and G. Thompson (eds) *Text Type and Texture*. London: Equinox.
- Cruttenden, A. (1997) *Intonation*, 2nd edn. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Crystal, D. (1969) *Prosodic Systems in English*. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Crystal, D. (1975) *The English Tone of Voice*. London: Edward Arnold.
- El Menoufy, A. (1969) A study of intonation in the grammar of English. Unpublished PhD dissertation, University College London.
- Eggins, S. (2004) *An Introduction to Systemic Functional Linguistics*, 2nd edn. London: Continuum
- Esser, J. (1988) *Comparing Reading and Speaking Intonation*. Amsterdam: Rodopi.
- Goffman, E. (1981) *Forms of Talk*. Oxford: Blackwell.
- Halliday, M. A. K. (1967) *Intonation and Grammar in British English*. The Hague: Mouton.
- Halliday, M. A. K. (1970) *A Course in Spoken English: Intonation*. London: Oxford University Press.

- Halliday, M. A. K. (2005) English intonation as a resource for discourse. In J. Webster (ed.) *Studies in the English Language: Collected Works of M. A. K. Halliday*, vol. 7, 287–92. London: Continuum.
- Halliday, M. A. K. and Greaves W. S. (2008) *Intonation in the Grammar of British English*. London: Equinox.
- Halliday, M. A. K. and Hasan, R. (1976) *Cohesion in English*. London: Longman.
- Halliday, M. A. K. and Matthiessen, C. M. I. M. (2004) *An Introduction to Functional Grammar*, 3rd edn. London: Edward Arnold.
- Hood, S. (2009) Texturing interpersonal meanings in academic argument: Pulses and prosodies of value. In G. Forey and G. Thompson (eds) *Text Type and Texture* 216–23. London: Equinox.
- Ladd, D. R. (2008) *Intonational Phonology*, 2nd edn. Cambridge: Cambridge University Press.
- Martin, J. R. (1992) *English Text: System and Structure*. Amsterdam: John Benjamins.
- Martin, J. R. and Rose, D. (2003) *Working with Discourse*. Continuum: London.
- Nation, I. S. P. (1984) Understanding paragraphs. *Language Learning and Communication* 3(1): 61–8.
- O'Grady, G. (2010) *A Grammar of Spoken English Discourse: The Intonation of Increments*. London: Continuum.
- Pierrehumbert, J. and Hirschberg, J. (1990) The meaning of intonation contours in the interpretation of discourse. In P. R. Cohen, J. Morgan and M. E. Pollack (eds) *Intentions in Communication* 271–312. Cambridge, MA: MIT Press.
- Smith, B. A. (2008) Intonational systems and register: A multidimensional exploration. Unpublished PhD dissertation, Macquarie University.
- Tench, P. (1990) *The Roles of Intonation in English Discourse*. Frankfurt am Main: Peter Lang.
- Tench, P. (1996) *The Intonation Systems of English*. London: Cassell.
- Tench, P. (1997) The fall and rise of the level tone. *Functions of Language* 4: 1–22.
- Wichmann, A. (2000) *Intonation in Text and Discourse: Beginnings, Middles and Ends*. London: Longman.

Appendix 1: Key to intonation notation

= tone unit boundary	\ = Falling tone
CAP = Prominent syllable	/\ = Rise-Falling tone
<u>CAP</u> = Tonic syllable	/ = Rising tone
↑CAP = High onset	\ / = Fall- Rising tone
↑ <u>CAP</u> = High tonic	– = Level tone
↓CAP = Low onset	↓ <u>CAP</u> = Low tonic

Appendix 2: Text marked up in stages with orthographic paragraph structure with orthographic paragraph notated by capital letters

Abstract

(A) I am just going to make a short statement to you on the terrible events that have happened in London earlier today,

Orientation

and I hope you understand that at the present time we are still trying to establish exactly what has happened, and there is a limit to what information I can give you, and I will simply try and tell you the information as best I can at the moment.

Incident

(B) It is reasonably clear that there have been a series of terrorist attacks in London. There are obviously casualties, both people that have died and people seriously injured, and our thoughts and prayers of course are with the victims and their families.

Repercussions

(C) It is my intention to leave the G8 within the next couple of hours and go down to London and get a report, face-to-face, with the police, and the emergency services and the Ministers that have been dealing with this, and then to return later this evening.

Interpretation

(D) It is the will of all the leaders at the G8 however that the meeting should continue in my absence, that we should continue to discuss the issues that we were going to discuss, and reach the conclusions which we were going to reach.

Orientation

Each of the countries round that table have some experience of the effects of terrorism and all the leaders, as they will indicate a little bit later, share our complete resolution to defeat this terrorism.

Evaluation

(E) It is particularly barbaric that this has happened on a day when people are meeting to try to help the problems of poverty in Africa, and the long term problems of climate change and the environment.

Incident repeat

Just as it is reasonably clear that this is a terrorist attack, or a series of terrorist attacks,

Thesis

it is also reasonably clear that it is designed and aimed to coincide with the opening of the G8.

Deferral

There will be time to talk later about this.

Argument/grounds

(F) It is important however that those engaged in terrorism realise that our determination to defend our values and our way of life is greater than their determination to cause death and destruction to innocent people in a desire to impose extremism on the world.

Argument/conclusion

Whatever they do, it is our determination that they will never succeed in destroying what we hold dear in this country and in other civilised nations throughout the world.

Appendix 3: The clause structure of the statement

1. 1 I am just going to make a short statement to you on the terrible events
= [[that have happened in London earlier today]],
+2 α and I hope
 'xβ you understand
 x'γ that at the present time we are still trying to establish x'[[exactly
 x'γ1what has happened]],
+3 and there is a limit =[[to what information I can give you]],
+4 and I will simply try and tell you the information
as best x'[[I can at the moment]].
2. 1 It is reasonably clear x'[[that there have been a series of terrorist attacks
in London]].
3. 1 1 There are obviously casualties, =[[both people =[[that have died]]
and people seriously injured]],
+2 and our thoughts and prayers of course are with the victims and
their families.
4. It is my intention +[[1 to leave the G8 within the next couple of hours
+2 and go down to London
+3 and get a report, face-to-face, with the police, and the emergency services
and the Ministers =[[that have been dealing with this,]]
+4 and then to return later this evening.

5. 1 It is the will of all the leaders at the G8 however
^x [[that the meeting should continue in my absence]],
⁺² that we should continue to discuss the issues
^x[[that we were going to discuss,]]
⁺³ and reach the conclusions "[[which we were going to reach.]]
6. 1 Each of the countries "[round that table] have some experience of the effects of terrorism
⁺² α and all the leaders,
^{xβ} [[as they will indicate a little bit later,]]
α share our complete resolution to defeat this terrorism.
7. 1αIt is particularly barbaric ^x[[that this has happened on a day]]
^{xβ} when people are meeting
^{xβ} to try to help the problems of poverty in Africa,
^{+γ}and the long term problems of climate change and the environment.]]
]]
8. 1 1α Just as it is reasonably clear
^x [[that this is a terrorist attack, or a series of terrorist attacks,]]
⁺² it is also reasonably clear
^x[[1 that it is designed
⁺² and aimed to coincide with the opening of the G8.]]
9. There will be time to talk later about this.
10. 1 It is important however,
[[that α those "[engaged in terrorism realise
'β that our determination^x[[to defend our values and our way of life]]
is greater than their determination ^x[[to cause death and destruction to
innocent people in a desire to impose extremism on the world]]].
11. ^{xβ} Whatever they do,
α it is our determination
^x[[that they will never succeed in destroying
^x [[what we hold dear in this country
and in other civilised nations throughout the world.]]]]

